



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 46

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Near Miss Reporting & Why It Matters

OVERVIEW:

A near miss is an unplanned, undesired event that, under slightly different circumstances, could have resulted in a serious injury or fatality. Near misses are not failures — they are the most valuable type of safety data available, because they reveal real hazards in the actual work environment before

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Research in occupational safety consistently shows that for every fatality in a workplace, there are approximately 30 serious injuries, 300 minor injuries, and thousands of near misses and unsafe conditions. This relationship — often called Heinrich's Triangle or the Safety Triangle — means that near misses are not rare events. On a busy construction job, near misses happen daily. The
2. There is no punishment for reporting a near miss at Allegheny Millwork. This is a firm policy. A worker who reports a near miss is doing the most valuable safety work possible — they are providing information that allows the hazard to be corrected before it hurts someone. If you have ever seen a supervisor react negatively to a near-miss report, that is not the culture we are building here.
3. When you report a near miss, give as much detail as possible. What were you doing? What happened? What could have happened if one or two things had been slightly different? Was it related to a tool, a condition, a procedure, or a behavior? The more specific the report, the more useful it is for identifying and correcting the underlying hazard. Vague reports lead to vague corrections that
4. Near-miss reports are reviewed, acted on, and communicated back to the crew. This feedback loop is what builds trust in the reporting system. If you report a hazard and never hear what happened with it, you are less likely to report the next one. We commit to closing the loop — when a near miss leads to a corrective action, you will hear about what changed and why.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Has anyone on this crew had a near miss this month that was not reported? Can you share what happened?
Q2: What would prevent you from reporting a near miss if you had one today?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Report ALL near misses to your supervisor — no matter how minor they seem
- Near miss reporting can be anonymous if needed — ask your supervisor
- A near miss is a system failure, not a personal failure or blame issue
- Investigating near misses is proven to prevent future serious accidents
- Unreported near misses are the #1 predictor of future serious incidents

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 46

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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